

Staff Dashboard Operations Manual

A practical guide for processing movie requests, helping patrons, maintaining kiosk content, and knowing when to use Polaris Leap.

Designed for everyday library staff

Clear steps • Large text • Troubleshooting • Screenshot placeholders

Most important rule

The PaxLib website does not check movies out to patrons. Staff must complete every checkout in Polaris Leap.

How the system fits together

The dashboard organizes requests and movie information. Polaris Leap remains the official circulation system.

THE THREE-PART WORKFLOW

1. PaxLib request

The patron chooses Get Now or Place a Hold on the kiosk.

2. Staff response

Staff locate the patron and movie using the dashboard.

3. Polaris Leap

Staff scan the movie to the patron's account in Leap.

Never mark Done too early

Mark a request complete only after the movie has been handled and, when appropriate, checked out in Polaris Leap.

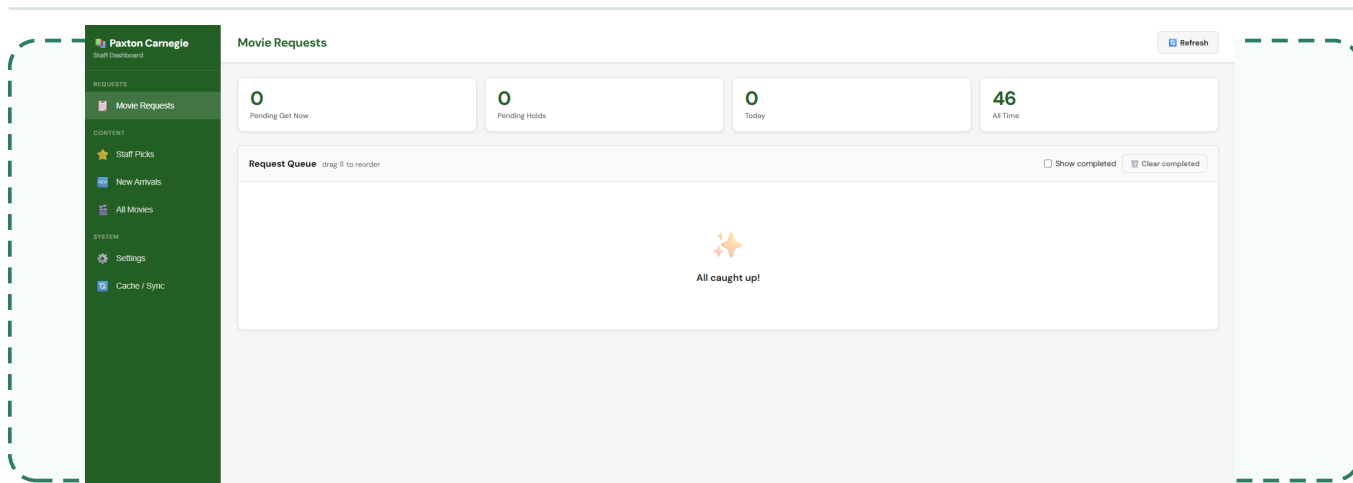
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SECTION 1

Open and navigate the dashboard

Use the left menu to move between requests, content tools, movie inventory, settings, and sync controls.



Opening the page

1. Open a web browser on the staff computer.
2. Go to v2.paxlib.xyz/staff/index.php.
3. Wait for the request counts and movie information to load.
4. Use the left sidebar to choose a section.

Menu item	What it is for
Movie Requests	Review and process Get Now and Hold requests.
Staff Picks	Choose titles shown in the kiosk Staff Picks row.
New Arrivals	Choose titles shown in the kiosk New Arrivals row.
All Movies	Search the inventory, copy barcodes, view status, and edit display information.
Settings	Control kiosk timeout, display rows, syncing, sounds, and auto-refresh.
Cache / Sync	Refresh the movie collection, build covers, and use maintenance tools.

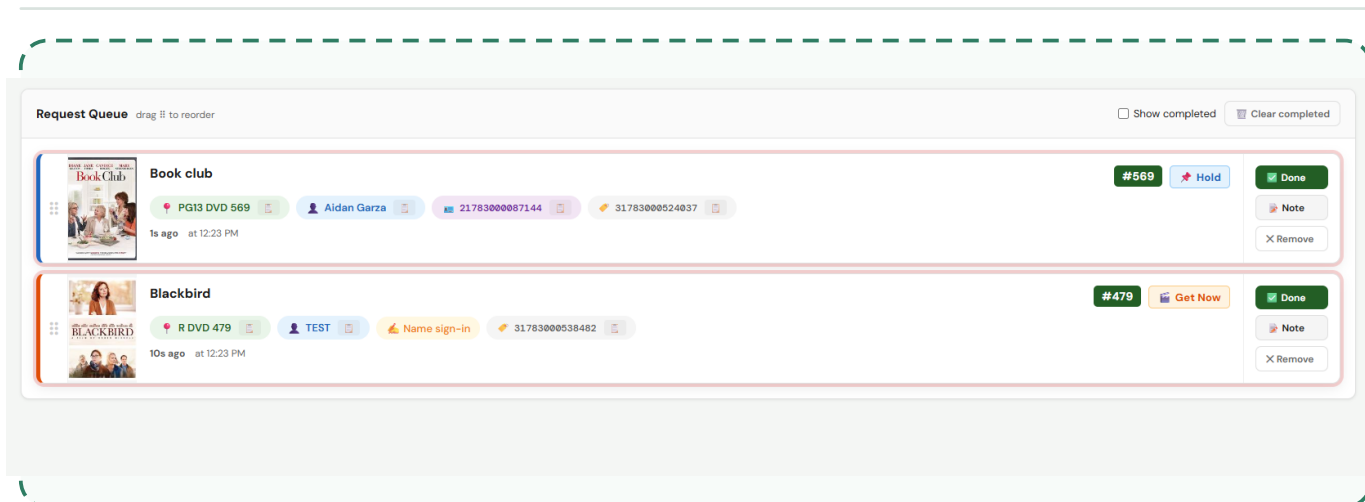
Refresh button

Use Refresh at the top right when a new patron request is expected but has not appeared yet. Auto-refresh normally checks every 10 seconds.

SECTION 2

Understand the request queue

Every patron request appears as a card. Read the request type, patron information, movie information, and current status before acting.



What the numbers mean

Counter	Meaning
Pending Get Now	Movies patrons want immediately.
Pending Holds	Movies patrons want reserved for later pickup.
Today	Requests submitted today.
All Time	Total requests recorded by the dashboard.

Request card controls

- Copy icon: Copies a patron barcode or movie barcode so it can be pasted into Polaris Leap.
- Note: Adds a staff note such as “Called patron,” “Movie not found,” or “Ready at desk.”
- Done: Marks the request completed. Use only when staff action is finished.
- Remove: Deletes the request from the queue. Use carefully.
- Show completed: Displays requests already marked Done.
- Clear completed: Permanently removes completed requests from the visible history.

Queue order

Use the drag handle to reorder requests when one needs priority. This changes the staff working order, not the patron’s Polaris account.

Process a Get Now request

A Get Now request means the patron wants an available movie now. The website tells staff what to retrieve; Polaris Leap performs the checkout.

GET NOW: STANDARD PROCEDURE

1. Open Movie Requests and locate the card labeled Get Now.
2. Read the patron name and copy the patron barcode when available.
3. Read or copy the movie barcode. Use the shelf number, call number, or title to find the physical movie.
4. Open Polaris Leap in a separate browser tab or window.
5. Find the patron in Leap by name, or paste/scan the copied patron barcode.
6. Confirm that the correct patron account is open.
7. Scan the physical movie barcode in Leap to check it out to that patron.
8. Confirm Leap shows a successful checkout and review any account alerts.
9. Return to the PaxLib staff page. Add a note when useful, then click Done.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Get Now request card beside Polaris Leap checkout screen

Use two screenshots or one combined image showing where the copied barcodes are used.

**The website
is not
circulation
software**

Copying barcodes or clicking Done does not check out the movie. The checkout is complete only after Polaris Leap accepts the item.

Process a Hold request

A Hold request means the patron wants the title reserved. Follow local library hold procedures and use Polaris Leap whenever the item is checked out or the patron account must be updated.

HOLD: STANDARD PROCEDURE

1. Locate the request card labeled Hold.
2. Confirm the patron name/barcode and movie title/barcode.
3. Check the movie's status and locate the physical item if it is currently in the library.
4. Use Polaris Leap to look up the patron by name or barcode when needed.
5. Follow the library's normal hold or pickup workflow. Place the item in the correct hold location and label it according to staff procedure.
6. Add a note such as Ready at desk, Patron contacted, or Currently checked out.
7. Click Done only after staff have completed the appropriate action.

When the movie is unavailable

Do not promise an immediate checkout. Note the situation, verify the item status in Polaris, and follow the library's regular hold process.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Hold request card and staff note area

Show the Hold badge, patron details, movie details, Note button, and Done button.

Use patron and item barcodes safely

The dashboard makes barcodes easy to copy. Always verify the patron and item in Polaris Leap before finishing the transaction.

Copying a patron barcode

1. Click the small copy button beside the patron barcode.
2. Open Polaris Leap and place the cursor in the patron search field.
3. Paste the barcode, then open the matching patron record.

Copying a movie barcode

1. Click the copy button beside the item barcode on the request card or All Movies page.
2. Use the number to verify the title, or scan the physical item during checkout.

Verify before scanning

Confirm the patron name on screen and confirm the physical disc/case matches the requested title. Similar titles and duplicate editions can have different barcodes.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Copy buttons beside patron and movie barcodes

Zoom in so older staff can see the copy icon clearly.

When there is no patron barcode

Use the patron's name from the request card to search in Polaris Leap. Ask for identifying information according to normal library policy before opening or changing an account.

When pasted text does not work

Click directly inside the Leap search box and paste again. If necessary, type the barcode manually or scan the patron's physical card.

Manage Staff Picks and New Arrivals

These pages control the special rows patrons see on the kiosk home screen.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Staff Picks selection page

Show selected tags, search field, movie list, and Save button.

Add a movie

1. Choose Staff Picks or New Arrivals from the sidebar.
2. Type part of the movie title in the search box.
3. Click the movie in the results list to add it to the selected row.
4. Repeat for additional titles.
5. Click Save before leaving the page.

Remove a movie

1. Find the movie in the selected tags near the top of the page.
2. Use the remove control on the tag.
3. Click Save.

Changes are not saved automatically

Always click Save. Leaving the page first may discard the selection changes.

Good selection practice

Keep the rows focused and useful. Remove titles that are no longer new, unavailable for long periods, or no longer recommended.

Search and edit the movie inventory

The All Movies page is the fastest place to verify shelf numbers, titles, barcodes, ratings, call numbers, and status.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

All Movies inventory table

Show search, movie count, Shelf #, Title, Barcode, Rating, Call #, Status, and Edit.

Search for a movie

1. Choose All Movies.
2. Type a title, barcode, or shelf number in the Search box.
3. Review the matching row and use the displayed information to locate the item.

Edit a movie display record

1. Click Edit on the movie row.
2. Change only the information that needs correction: cover, title, rating, call number, location, or description.
3. Click Save Changes.

Edits are overrides

Manual edits take priority over synced Polaris data. A future movie sync will not normally erase those edits unless all overrides are cleared.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Edit Movie window

Show cover upload, title, rating, call number, location, description, and Save Changes.

Kiosk settings

Most staff should leave these values alone unless there is a specific reason to change kiosk behavior.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Kiosk Settings page

Show the toggles, timeout values, and Save Settings button.

Setting	What it controls	Suggested approach
Library Name	Name displayed on the kiosk.	Change only for an approved branding update.
Inactivity Timeout	Time before the kiosk asks whether the patron is still there.	Keep long enough for older patrons to read and browse.
Warning Duration	Countdown before automatic logout.	Allow enough time for a patron to respond.
Show Staff Picks	Displays or hides the Staff Picks row.	Leave on when the row is maintained.
Show New Arrivals	Displays or hides the New Arrivals row.	Leave on when the row is maintained.
Auto-sync movies	Refreshes stale movie data from Polaris.	Normally leave enabled.
Sync interval	How often stale movie data is refreshed.	Use the library's approved interval.
Sound Notifications	Plays a sound for new requests.	Enable on the staff workstation when useful.
Auto-refresh	Checks for new requests every 10 seconds.	Normally leave enabled.

Save Settings

After any approved change, click Save Settings and test the kiosk.

Sync and maintenance tools

Use these controls when movie information or covers are out of date. Avoid destructive maintenance options unless you understand their effect.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Cache / Sync page

Show Sync Movies from Polaris, Build Missing Covers, legacy cache, single cover refresh, and CI

Tool	Use it when	What it does
Sync Movies from Polaris	Titles, barcodes, shelf information, or In/Out status are stale.	Rebuilds the movie list from the Polaris recordset.
Build Missing Covers	Movies are present but some posters are blank.	Fetches missing cover images in batches.
Reset Legacy Availability Cache	Only when instructed for an old cache problem.	Clears old availability data; not needed in normal operation.
Refresh Cover for Single Movie	One movie has a missing or incorrect cover.	Refreshes that movie using its barcode.
Clear All Overrides	Only when approved and all custom edits should be discarded.	Resets custom titles, covers, ratings, and other edits back to synced data.

Do not interrupt a sync

A full sync may take time. Leave the page open and wait for a success or error message before clicking again.

Clear All Overrides is destructive

This can erase staff corrections and custom covers. Use only with approval or when intentionally returning every movie to Polaris data.

Troubleshooting

Work from the simplest fix first. Do not repeatedly click buttons while a page is loading or syncing.

Problem	What to do
A request is missing	Wait 10 seconds, click Refresh, and confirm the patron completed the kiosk request.
Patron barcode will not paste	Click inside the Leap search field, paste again, or type/scan the physical card.
Patron cannot be found	Search by name in Polaris Leap and verify spelling. Follow normal identity verification rules.
Movie cannot be found on the shelf	Check shelf number, call number, title, and status. Verify in Polaris before promising availability.
Movie status looks wrong	Run Sync Movies from Polaris, then reload the page.
Cover is blank	Build Missing Covers, or refresh the single movie by barcode.
Page looks frozen	Wait briefly, refresh the browser once, then reopen the staff page if needed.
New request sound does not play	Check Sound Notifications in Settings and the computer volume.
Requests are not updating	Confirm Auto-refresh is enabled, click Refresh, and verify the internet connection.
Sync fails	Do not keep clicking. Record the error message and report it to the person maintaining PaxLib.
Wrong request was marked Done	Turn on Show completed. Review the card and add a clear note; contact the system maintainer if it must be restored.

Protect patron privacy

Do not leave a patron account open in Polaris Leap. Close or clear the patron record after the transaction and do not write barcodes on public notes.

Daily staff checklist

Use this page as a one-page reference near the staff workstation.

START OF DAY

- ☐ Open the PaxLib staff dashboard.
- ☐ Confirm request counts load.
- ☐ Make sure Auto-refresh is enabled.
- ☐ Open Polaris Leap and sign in according to library procedure.
- ☐ Test that a movie search works.

FOR EACH REQUEST

- ☐ Read whether it is Get Now or Hold.
- ☐ Verify the patron name/barcode.
- ☐ Verify the movie title/barcode and locate the physical item.
- ☐ Use Polaris Leap for the actual checkout or patron-account work.
- ☐ Add a note when useful.
- ☐ Mark Done only after staff action is complete.

END OF DAY

- ☐ Review any requests still pending.
- ☐ Add notes to requests that need follow-up.
- ☐ Make sure no patron record is left open in Polaris Leap.
- ☐ Report sync errors, missing data, or repeated problems.

Remember

PaxLib organizes the request. Polaris Leap completes the circulation transaction.

SCREENSHOT PLACEHOLDER

Optional: final annotated staff dashboard overview

Add one labeled overview image with arrows to each major menu section.